How to write claim notes anyone can act on

Every follow-up should survive being handed to another person

The test is simple: a rep who has never seen the claim should be able to read your note and make the next call without opening three other screens. If they cannot, the note is a diary entry.

EVERY NOTE ANSWERS FOUR QUESTIONS

- ☐ **Who and when:** date, the rep you spoke to and their title, your initials.
- ☐ **What is the proof:** claim number, payer, clearinghouse trace or reference number.
- ☐ **What did you do:** what you sent or said, and what they told you. Exact, not "followed up".
- ☐ **What happens next:** the next action, who owns it, and the date it is due.

THE TEMPLATE

- ☐ **Date:** _____
- ☐ **Claim # / payer:** _____
- ☐ **Status:** _____
- ☐ **Action taken:** _____
- ☐ **Rep name and title:** _____
- ☐ **Reference #:** _____
- ☐ **Next step and due date:** _____
- ☐ **Initials:** _____

Worked example

6/28 · Delta claim 4471 · status: attachment rejected.
Spoke to Dana R., claims supervisor. Resent pre-op PA and chart note, ref 88214. She confirmed the packet is on the review queue.
Next: recheck 7/10; if still pending, escalate with the clearinghouse trace ID.
LS

RULES THAT KEEP NOTES USEFUL

1. **No claim sits untouched for more than 14 days.** Put the next date in the note, not in your memory.
2. **Write the next step before you close the call.** If you do not know it, ask for it while they are still on the line.
3. **A reference number or the note is a rumour.** No number means you will start the investigation again next month.
4. **Name the person, never "the rep".** Escalation needs someone to escalate to.

Our team logs every claim to resolution.

Every claim we hold gets a dated note, a named owner and a next-step date. You see the trail in your report.

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